

Rep. Tom Emmer on The Jon Justice Show

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JOHN:

and I am very pleased to welcome on a Monday morning a post-midterm RNC GLO representative Tom Emmer. Good morning, Tom. Thank you so much for coming on this morning.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, good to be with you, John. Good morning. Happy Monday.

JOHN:

Happy Monday to you, too. And congratulations on that rousing speech at the RNC last week. I don't know if you're aware of this, but it certainly got a lot of positive attention online in the wake of your time up on stage at that event. What's your biggest takeaway from last week's midterm RNC?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, it's that there's a lot more energy out there than the mainstream media would like us to believe, John. It's pretty interesting. You know, if our people show up on November 3rd, our people being the Trump supporters, Republican supporters, if they recognize that this really is a choice between freedom, constitutional freedom that this country is supposed to afford and communism, which is what the choice is, they'll show up on November 3rd and we'll do great. If we follow the same thing that midterms typically follow, which is the party that's in the White House is fat and happy and they don't necessarily all show up the way they should, well, then you got trouble. And let's just say the communists, the Marxists, the anarchists are extremely motivated by their hatred of Donald Trump and everything we stand for. I think that convention last week showed me, it gave me some encouragement, John, that our people are definitely engaged and are ready to get out and vote.

JOHN:

Well, and we're only, correct me if I'm wrong here, but we're kind of eyeballing what, some 16 House seats and six or seven Senate seats. Do I have those numbers correct of the races that we're watching closely?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Yeah, I think you're closer than the professionals because seriously, John, they will tell you that there's probably 209 safe Republican seats in the House and there's 205 safe Democrats in the House, which leaves you, I believe, 21 or something that are the field, but I think you're closer. I think what we're really going to be talking about going into this last stretch, this last 50 days, are two things. One, keeping everybody we already have, holding the seats we already have. Cheapest seat to win is the one you already hold. And then that's the field, right? Up to 20 some seats, but I think it's going to come down to 10 to 15. That's why I think you're pretty close.

JOHN:

Do you, how does this compare, let me back up, heading into the last presidential race, you know, I remembered just, you know, what the four years of what Biden had done, the way the left had react, you know, had reacted. This was a win doing that thing with my fingers of Joe Biden, where I think the expectation for a lot of people that voted for Biden was that, you know, Biden would be the adult in the room, but we would continue on the economic prosperity we were dealing with. And we just wouldn't have to hear about Trump anymore. And clearly that wasn't the case. We got four years of radical, progressive policies under Biden, millions let in via the border. This goes on and on. It seems like we were in a very similar situation, just the details have changed heading into this election as well. Do you feel the same way? Because that felt like a referendum heading into that last presidential election against the left and their radical policies. And it feels like this is the same thing that we're dealing with this time around in the midterms.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, they're trying to make it feel that way, John, for sure. The last election, I would call it a change election because we just couldn't take four more years of Biden's disastrous economic policies, double digit inflation that we hadn't seen in this country for 40 years. Everything was going through the roof. Now, the Democrats just can't believe the hypocrisy of these guys. They created the train wreck, the economic train wreck. Donald Trump and Republicans have been pulling us out of it. And I'll tell you what, we're not all the way there yet, John. There are challenges in the economy. But here's the thing. There's a ton of good news going on. I mean, they choose the word affordability, in my humble opinion, because it's just another word for the economy. The election is always about the economy. And in this case, you pick affordability because you can now pluck out the trees that you want to focus on. We're going to focus on gas prices, probably the best thing that they can focus on. Why? Because we don't fill our tank every day, but we do drive by that sign every day, John. So we're reminded regularly. And by the way, it really doesn't help to tell them that we're still well below where the highest gas price got in the Biden era for at least the regular and unleaded stuff. But price of eggs is down to pre-pandemic amounts. So why don't we talk about that? Oh, no, we're going to talk about beef because beef is higher. So yes, they are trying to manufacture that same thing on our side. But here's the problem I have. While perception needs to catch up with the reality of this economy, which is just look at the jobs report last week, John, three times anything that they expected. And they weren't creating jobs for the gig economy, right? Not for Uber, not for DoorDash. These are high tech jobs. These are manufacturing jobs with the billions being reinvested in this country that are high paying jobs with benefits. I mean, there are great things happening in the economy. So I'll stop here. It's interesting. They're spending consumer spending is up 6% from a year ago, John, the behavior does not match the perception that they want us to believe. So is it a change election? No, I think it's more of a choice election. It's a choice between common sense and communism.

JOHN:

Well, and I'm not the first one to point this out. And maybe I'm in the minority here. But when we talk about the gas prices, and as you mentioned, comparing them, they were still higher under Biden. For me personally, if it means keeping Iran from developing a nuclear weapon, and stripping away their ability to potentially wage war against us, and certainly, you know, our men and women service members overseas and our allies, if that means that I have to pay a little bit higher price at the pump for a period of time, I'm personally okay with that, which is certainly much different than why Joe Biden had the gas prices where they were when he was in office. And I know I might be in the minority in that sense. But do you feel as if Trump is going to be able to sort of rein in what's happening with Iran to get those prices down somewhat prior to November?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, that's anybody's guess. I mean, they are devastated, John, they being the IRGC and the ayatollahs. And by the way, the Iranian people are getting feeling the pain. I mean, they have they have lines for gas that I'm told are three miles long. They're having trouble getting the basic necessities of life, food, and water. This is reaching some pretty serious stages of the conflict. That being said, the IRGC and the ayatollahs, and there was a report out over the weekend that the Chinese, which I'm sure Xi and Trump will talk about when they get together here shortly, the Chinese, their satellites identified targets for the Iranians with their drones. So I mean, this is what you're battling. I can't tell you that it's going to be over tomorrow. But I agree with you. I don't think you're in the minority. I think you just happen to be one of those folks that's talking about it. I think most Americans, these political elitists here in Washington, DC and writing for these ridiculous papers, including the Wall Street Journal, that seems to want to point out that, oh, we're not doing well in Iran. We are. Navy's gone. All of their infrastructure is gone. They're actually failing as a country and the sanctions are working. When that finally brings them to the ground, John, that's anyone's guess. But the strain is moving again, and it's going to continue to move. So if we could solve the problem, by the way, we could do it overnight by repealing a law in this country that forces us to put our oil on the world market. Why don't we just satisfy American needs first? We should do that. That would solve the problem very quickly.

JOHN:

Talking with Representative Tom Emmer, one last thing before I let you go. Let's just talk about the game plan for the House to keep power in the House. I know there's a focus on some key districts, but I'm curious. We had some redistricting that took place in Texas and Florida. Is that going to make a tangible difference in your mind in retaining control of the House?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Yeah, absolutely. I mean, they did some redistricting on their side. They now have 21 of their members, I think it's 21 or 22, are in seats that Donald Trump won in the last presidential cycle, John. So they've got a big challenge on their hands. We start out, if you want to be extremely conservative with their redistricting, we lost four seats in California. We lost one seat in Salt Lake City, Utah. Now you're going to get Maine, so now you're minus a net minus four. You're going to get Tennessee, net minus three. You're going to get Alabama, net minus two. You're going to get Louisiana, net minus one. You haven't even talked about Texas or Florida. Florida's got up to four that we can pick up, and Texas has up to five that we can pick up. So all these people that say the House is lost and it's going to flip, it's the same nonsense they do every two years. The prognosticators, either to excite us, they tell us that we're going to have a red wave, right? And so everybody gets all excited when you don't have a red wave because you were never going to have a red wave. They express disappointment. Why didn't they perform as well? The other side of it is you're going to lose 24 seats. You remember that one? The week before the 2020 election, you're going to lose 24 seats in the House. John, we beat 12 Democrats that night. We almost flipped the House in a two-year presidential cycle for the first time in 50 years. So look, the mechanics are good. You got to stick the landing, though, at the end, and I think your questions are pretty timely when we're talking about the conflict in Iran and when we're talking about people's perception of what is happening in our economy.

JOHN:

Well, I feel like I stuck the landing on our conversation this morning. Representative Tom Emmer, as always, it's great to see you and to speak with you, and I hope we can do the same again next week.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Look forward to it, John. Take care.

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